Dishant Desle

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity master's candidate at the University of Denver, graduating August 2026, focused on AI and agent security, application security, and detection engineering. Most of my work is building security tools and finding real bugs with them. My MCP server scanner turned up six vulnerabilities in published servers, including an SSRF in Anthropic's reference server, which I proved on AWS EC2 by pulling live IAM credentials. I also wrote AgentSploit, an offensive testing framework for AI agents, and published it on PyPI. Comfortable with SIEM detection, incident response, penetration testing, and vulnerability management, and have competed on blue teams at RMCCDC Regionals, DOE CyberForce, and the Trace Labs OSINT CTF at DEF CON 34.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- AI / agent security: LLM red teaming, prompt injection and indirect tool injection, MCP security, RAG pipeline security, LLM-as-judge evaluation, Anthropic / OpenAI / Ollama APIs
- Application security: SAST, DAST, penetration testing, vulnerability scanning and management, API security testing, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, OpenVAS, coordinated and CVE-track disclosure, CI security gating, SARIF
- Detection and incident response: SIEM (Splunk, ELK Stack), Suricata, Snort, Wireshark, IDS/IPS, detection rules, threat detection, threat hunting, log analysis and forensics, persistence removal, security operations, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF
- Cloud and identity: AWS (IAM, S3, KMS, EC2, IMDS), GCP IAM, Okta, Active Directory, Google Workspace, HashiCorp Vault
- Programming and tools: Python, Go, Bash, SQL, C, C++, TypeScript, FastAPI, pytest, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, Linux

SECURITY PROJECTS

mcp-witness, MCP server security scanner (Python)

- Wrote a static and dynamic scanner for MCP servers, with 15 static rules and 7 dynamic test scenarios covering SSRF, path traversal, shell injection, prompt injection, DNS rebinding, and CORS misconfiguration.
- Reported six vulnerabilities through coordinated disclosure, including an SSRF in Anthropic's mcp-server-fetch, proven on AWS EC2 by retrieving live IAM credentials. Filed CVE requests and confirmed the upstream fix.

AgentSploit, offensive testing framework for AI agents and MCP servers (Python, PyPI)

- Built a framework of 11 modules for testing agent systems: MCP scanning, prompt-injection payloads delivered through PDF, email, and calendar files, a mapper that traces attack paths from untrusted inputs to sensitive tools against live Claude and OpenAI agents, and memory, RAG, and conversation-thread poisoning.

Afterlife, cross-cloud identity and access auditor (Python, FastAPI)

- Pulls identities and credentials from eight systems (AWS, GCP, Okta, GitHub, HashiCorp Vault) into one graph and flags leftover access with 11 rules such as OFFBOARDED-OWNER and UNROTATED-KEY. Covered by 250+ tests, with JSON, HTML, PDF, and SARIF reports.

mllm-scan, on-device LLM measurement study (Python, master's capstone)

- A static scanner that detects on-device LLMs inside Android apps. Scanned 1,001 apps and identified a new threat class, Mutable-Reference Model Substitution.

CYBERSECURITY COMPETITIONS

- Trace Labs OSINT Search Party CTF, DEF CON 34 (Aug 2026): placed 5th of more than 100 teams; the leads produced go to law enforcement for active missing-persons cases, handled under chain-of-custody.
- RMCCDC Regionals (Mar 2026): first University of Denver team to qualify. Defended Active Directory, DNS, IIS, and Linux against a live Red Team and wrote the incident response reports for White Team injects.
- DOE CyberForce (Nov 2025): defended an ICS/OT environment, removing PAM backdoors, web shells, and port-based persistence.

EXPERIENCE

University of Denver, Ritchie Center | Denver, CO | Facility / Service Associate, part-time | Mar 2025 to Aug 2026

- Handled physical access control and identity verification across campus facilities, logged incidents, and worked with campus safety on emergency response.

University of Illinois Chicago, Elicit Lab | Chicago, IL | Lead Frontend Developer and Undergraduate Research Assistant | Dec 2022 to May 2023

- Took first place at the UIC Undergraduate Research Forum in 2023. Led the UI/UX design and prototyping for a spherical-display research project and analyzed logs and A/V data to understand how people used it.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- M.S. in Cyber Security, University of Denver, August 2026
- B.S. in Computer Science, University of Illinois Chicago, May 2024
- Antisyphon Professionally API Testing (2026); Google Cybersecurity and Google Cloud Cybersecurity, Coursera (2026); TryHackMe Jr Penetration Tester (2025)